

Positioning, Flows, and Observations Across the Floor

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Portfolio Manager's Summary

US stocks traded higher Friday with the S&P 500 -0.3% on the week, as investors have been digesting a weak NFP, an in-line ISM Manufacturing survey, and an increasingly demanding macro backdrop (oil, rates, geopolitics). Optical Networks, Momentum Longs, and Data Centers were among the themes that outperformed, while Quantum Computing, Rare Earths, and Gold Miners were among the themes that underperformed.

- **Prime:** US Fundamental L/S Net leverage decreased for a third consecutive week by -2.2 pts to 46.4% – the lowest level since Apr '25 (around "Liberation Day") and approaching five-year lows in the 2nd percentile. From a flow perspective, US equities were modestly net bought on the week, driven by short covering in Macro Products partially offset by shorting in Single Stocks. 8 of 11 sectors were net sold, led by Comm Svcs, Consumer Discretionary, and Materials, while Health Care was by far the most net bought driven by aggressive short covering (still net sold month/month).
- **Shares:** NDX eclipsed a new ATH to end the week, blowing through previous highs set on 6/3 and 9/22. Asset Mgrs and HF equity flows finished balanced on the week with one notable theme: uptick of demand in Semis on positive catalysts (solid MU earnings, NVDA \$150bn buyback increase, etc). Overall, it feels like there is minimal willingness to chase this move higher despite light positioning. Activity levels remain spotty given performance challenges, increasingly demanding macro backdrop, looming midterm overhang, and high velocity narrative shifts within AI.
- **Futures:** Russell 2K positioning is deeply depressed via the futures lens, with GS estimating systematic exposure in the 7th percentile and leveraged funds carrying record short exposure, according to CFTC data as of 9/22. Softer PCE and NFP data have eased rate expectations, with 30bp now priced through year-end, sparking short covering: OI has declined by \$900 million since 9/29, while RTY funding spreads have richened both outright and relative to SPX. Sustained Russell 2K outperformance, however, will require durable relief in rates before end-user length can rebuild.
- **Derivatives:** As we head into Q3 earnings and midterms, the desk likes IWM and QQQ upside to capture the asymmetry. This week we have seen plenty of activity on the exotic products front, specifically in NDX as it provides an attractive way to play for tech outperformance into earnings. The desk traded over 140mm of NDX Dec26 105% 115% Up and Out Calls, which are currently trading in the 43rd percentile, slightly below average (vs 1.60% offer for the vanilla call spread). We also like NDX > RTY outperformance and NDX upvar as ways to isolate tech outperformance.
- **ETFs:** Recent activity has illustrated the cross-asset firepower that ETFs offer (stats as of 9/29): 1) SPX is on track to outperform RTY for 7 straight weeks (longest streak since 2018), driven by strength in mega caps – MAGS has garnered 12 inflows over the past 13 sessions. 2) AI-fueled demand for cybersecurity exposure has the ETF complex on track for one of its best monthly inflows (+\$950mm). 3) In the fund's near 25 years of operating history, TLT hit an all-time low this week and is on track for losses over 7 straight sessions (its longest daily stretch lower in 2 years).
- **Baskets:** Friday's softer payroll print pushed yields lower without being soft enough to spark recession fears – this could provide a strong tailwind for equities where weak market breadth and light net positioning leave room for a catch-up rally from laggards. For upside exposure on high-beta stocks, we like our GS sector/industry-neutral basket (GSPUBETA). For investors looking to manage beta exposure, we like hedging with our Beta-ex-AI pair (GSPUBETX). Separately, we hosted a webinar ([link](#)) with GS research analysts: Carly Davenport, Joe Ritchie, Adam Bubes, and Olivia Foster, to discuss the future of US power demand and the upcoming catalysts driving the POWER UP AMERICA theme (GSX1POW1).
- **Sector Specialists: TMT: Semis continued to re-gain their footing (SOX +4% vs NDX +70bps) in another long week with continued factor rotations under the surface (see our High Beta Mo' Pair +8% on the week).** The past five days have delivered TMT Investors "wrong-way" reactions to earnings prints (ACN to the upside, muted MU reaction & JBL fade), Developer Days, AI Model releases, and an ever-present focus on the macro landscape to reckon with. Zooming out, as pencil sharpening of expectations begins ahead of EPS season, the valuation backdrop looks un-demanding with NDX's 12m forward multiple sitting below its multi-year average. **Energy: 'Fade energy' continues to dominate conversations on the desk with specialists** – with more caution on relative upside to crude at current levels and potential policy intervention on the products front. **Refining has been the most topical subsector on the desk** – with strong inbounds on potential knock-on effects of a diesel export ban or quota. OFS conversations are broadly highlighting near term downside risk to International exposed names, while NAM is more idiosyncratic on the pricing / utilization fronts. Where are conversations turning more positive? Integrated (US + CAD) – the group has lagged YTD relative to broader Energy, generally more defensive in an Energy pullback and 3Q setups are expected to be strong – specifically on trading and downstream.

What We Are Reading and Listening to This Week

- **US Banks:** Overlooking the Fed's CCAR final rules and proposal ([link](#))
- **Relaunching Our US Election Monitor for the Midterms** ([link](#))
- **The EM Trader: Brazil** – Votes, Volatility and Value ([link](#))
- **The Breaks of the Game:** Yields and Fed's Reaction Function ([link](#))

	S&P 500	Nasdaq 100	Russell 2000	STOXX 600	Nikkei 225	HSI	CSI 300	SPX 1-M Realized Correlation	VIX	10Y UST	US Dollar	WTI Future	Gold Future	Bitcoin
Level	7,722.72	30,807.93	2,832.90	631.35	68,309.46	23,972.29	4,357.62	11.0%	15.31	5.27%	101.93	91.48	4,143.80	84,424.70
WoW Chg	-0.3%	0.7%	-0.2%	-1.1%	2.9%	-2.2%	-1.8%	2.0 pp	3.0%	0.11 pp	0.9%	-1.0%	-3.4%	0.7%
YTD Chg	12.8%	22.0%	14.1%	6.6%	35.7%	-6.5%	-5.9%	-0.9 pp	2.4%	1.10 pp	3.7%	59.3%	-4.5%	-3.7%

Macro/Thematic Baskets: Top Performers This week				
Basket	Ticker	WoW Price Chg	YTD Price Chg	
Optical Networks	GSXUOPTI	9.09%	93.07%	
High Beta 12M Winners	GSXUHMOM	4.48%	44.09%	
800V Data Centers	GSXG800V	4.10%	49.16%	
US Momentum (Hi/Low)	GSP1MOMO	3.92%	6.20%	
Datacenters	GSTMTDAT	3.35%	90.15%	

Macro/Thematic Baskets: Bottom Performers This week				
Basket	Ticker	WoW Price Chg	YTD Price Chg	
Bitcoin Sensitive	GSCBBTC1	-5.63%	46.48%	
Quantum Computing (Index)	GSX1QNT1	-5.59%	-19.14%	
Global Rare Earths	GSXGRARE	-5.57%	-11.63%	
Global Goldminers	GSXGOLDM	-5.30%	5.49%	
AI China ADRs	GSCBCCAI	-5.29%	-29.89%	

Macro/Thematic Pairs: Top Performers This week				
Basket	Ticker	WoW Price Chg	YTD Price Chg	
Hi Growth Hi Margin vs Lo Margin	GSPUHGMP	3.09%	44.49%	
Low Income Consumer vs Housing	GSPULOHO	2.67%	-1.98%	
Secular Growth vs Bond Proxies	GSPUSGBO	2.54%	19.92%	
Small Cap Hi vs Lo Profitability	GSPUPROF	1.96%	-4.20%	
Software Immune vs At-Risk	GSPUSFTX	1.60%	45.64%	

Macro/Thematic Pairs: Bottom Performers This week				
Basket	Ticker	WoW Price Chg	YTD Price Chg	
Long Value vs Secular Growth	GSPUVLSG	-4.20%	-1.23%	
China vs US Internet	GSPRUCIT	-3.74%	-20.68%	
AI Power vs AI Hardware ex-Power	GSPUAIPO	-3.73%	-55.24%	
GLP-1 Exposed vs At Risk	GSPUGLPP	-2.42%	2.71%	
Secular vs NonSecular Non-Profit Tech	GSPUSNOP	-2.22%	2.67%	

Track these themes with the GS Custom Baskets Launchpad on Bloomberg: please reach out to your sales coverage and gs-gssu.permissioning@gs.com
Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities data as of 2-Oct-26. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

Prime Services

Vincent Lin, CFA, FRM
vincent.lin@gs.com

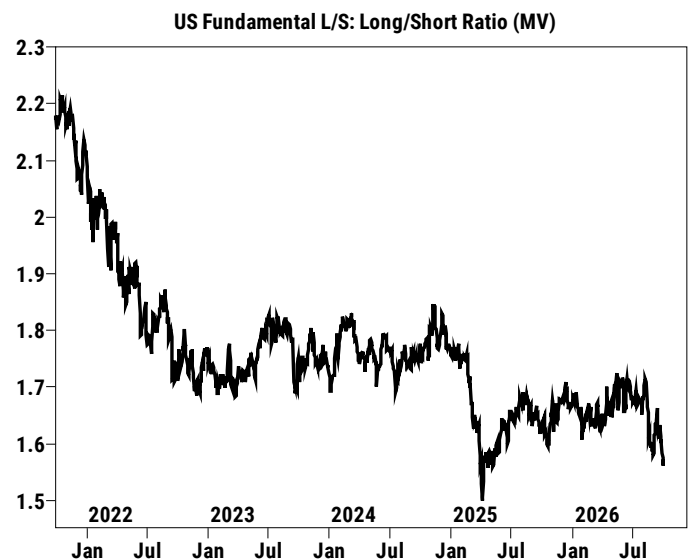
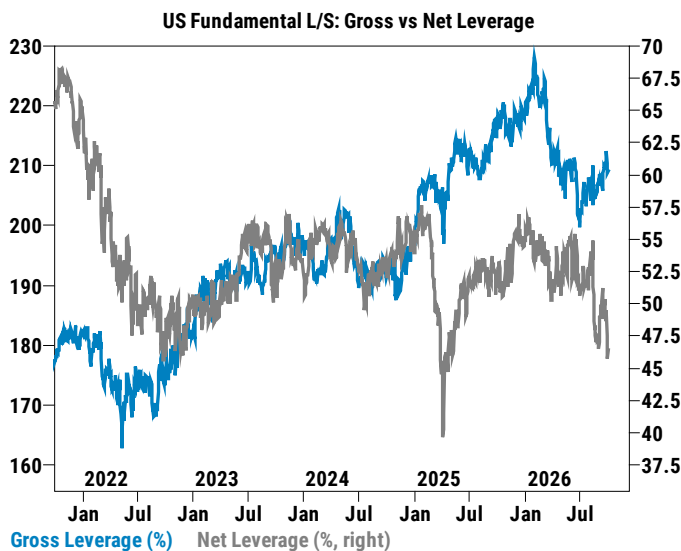
Marco Laicini, PhD
marco.laicini@gs.com

Erin Tolar
erin.tolar@gs.com

Freddie Parker, CFA
freddie.parker@gs.com

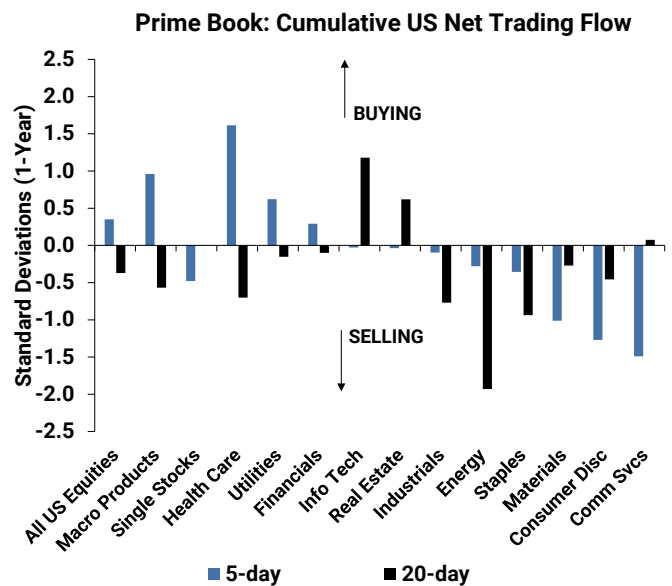
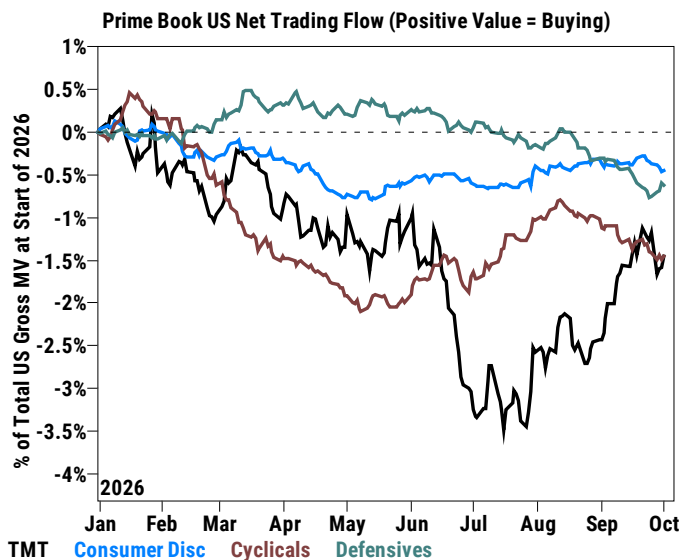
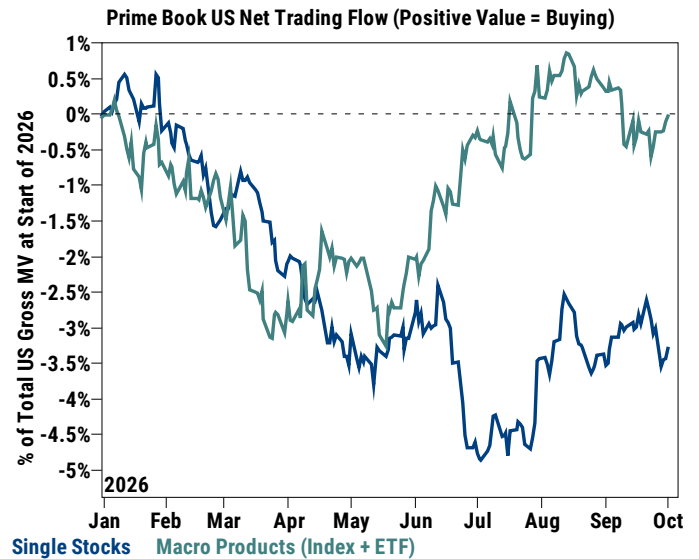
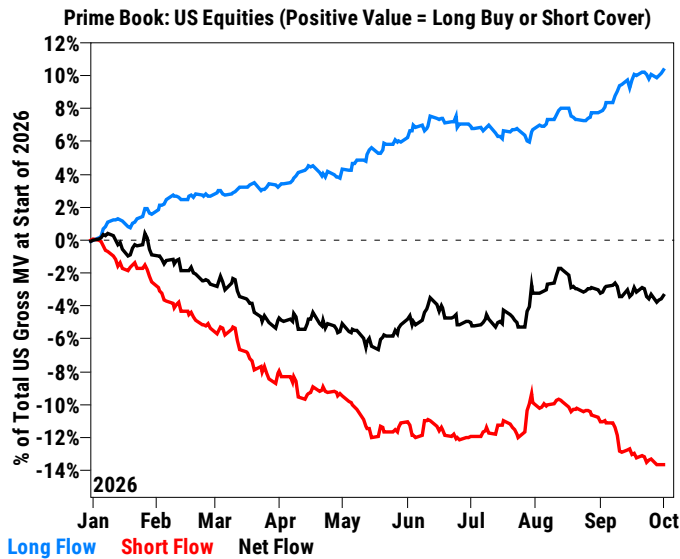
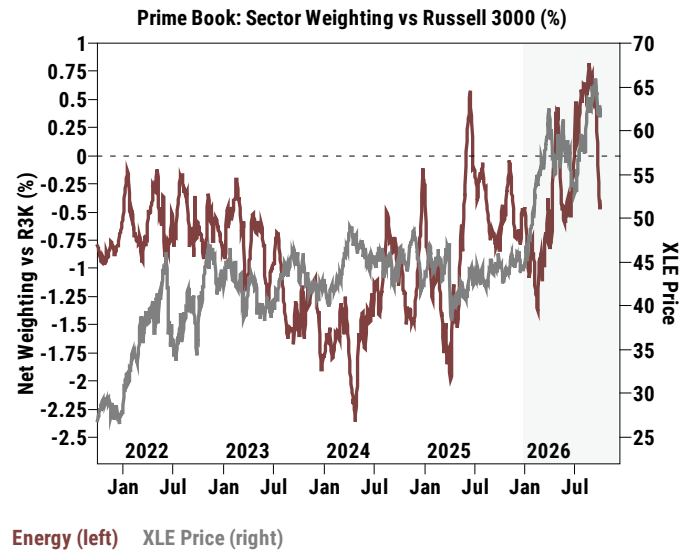
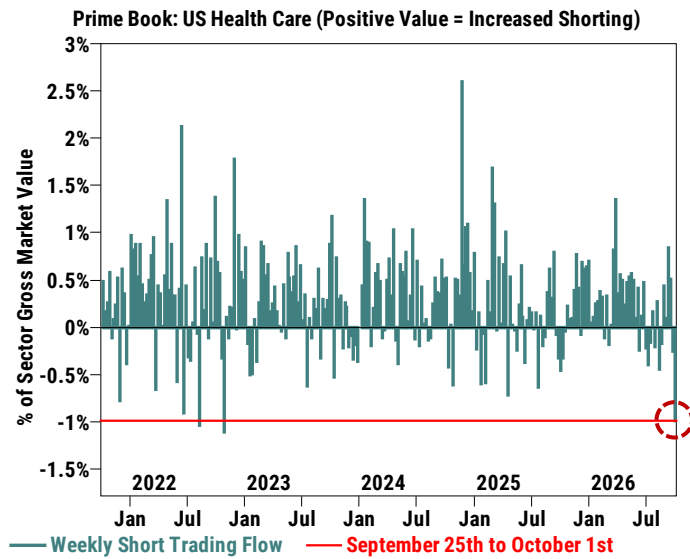
Risk Exposures: US L/S Gross leverage fell -1.4 pts to 209.2% (34th percentile one-year), while US L/S Net leverage decreased for a third consecutive week by -2.2 pts to 46.4% – the lowest level since Apr '25 (around "Liberation Day") and approaching five-year lows in the 2nd percentile. US Fundamental long/short ratio (MV) decreased -1.9% to 1.57 (1st percentile five-year).

US Fundamental L/S (Asset Weighted)			
Leverage	Gross %	Net %	L/S Ratio (MV)
Current	209.2	46.4	1.570
WoW Chg	-1.4pt	-2.2pt	-1.9%
October MTD Chg	0.5pt	0.7pt	0.6%
2026 YTD Chg	-9.4pt	-8.5pt	-6.0%
2025 Chg	21.9pt	0.9pt	-4.9%
Current 1-Yr Percentile	34%	0%	0%
Current 3-Yr Percentile	65%	3%	2%
Current 5-Yr Percentile	79%	2%	1%



Trading Flows (September 25th – October 1st): US equities were modestly net bought on the week (+0.4 SDs 1-year), driven by short covering in Macro Products partially offset by continued shorting in Single Stocks.

- **Macro Products (Index and ETF combined)** saw the largest net buying in two months (+1.0 SDs 1-year), driven mainly by short covers. US-listed ETF shorts decreased for a second straight week by -1.6%, led by covering in Credit, Tech, and Financials ETFs partially offset by shorting in Health Care, Asia-Pac, and Large Cap Equity ETFs.
- **Single Stocks collectively** were net sold for a second straight week (-0.5 SDs 1-year), driven again by short sales outpacing long buys (1.5 to 1). **8 of 11 US sectors were net sold**, led in \$ terms by Comm Svcs, Consumer Discretionary, Materials, and Staples, while Health Care, Utilities, and Financials were the only net bought sectors.
- **After selling the sector for six straight weeks**, hedge funds net bought US Health Care stocks at the fastest pace in more than six months (+1.6 SDs 1-year), driven almost entirely by short covers – this week's short covering was the largest since Oct' 22 and ranks in the 99th percentile on a 5-year lookback. Nearly all subsectors were net bought this week, led by Biotech, Pharmaceuticals, and Life Sciences Tools & Svcs, all of which were driven by short covers. Aggregate US Health long/short ratio now stands at 2.29, near 1-year lows in the 2nd percentile and in the 21st percentile vs. the past five years.
- **US Energy stocks collectively** were net sold for a sixth straight week (8 of last 9), driven by short sales outpacing long buys (2 to 1). While oil prices remain near multi-year highs, on a month/month basis Energy is the most net sold US sector on the Prime book in both \$ and SD terms (-1.9 SDs 1-year), driven almost entirely by short sales – Oil & Gas Refining & Marketing, and to a lesser extent Oil & Gas Equip & Svcs and Integrated Oil & Gas have been the most net sold subsectors. **Hedge funds are now U/W Energy stocks by -0.4% relative to the Russel 3000 (vs. 5-year high of +1% O/W seen in July), in the 57th percentile vs. the past year and 82nd percentile vs. the past five years.**



Source for all graphs and tables: Goldman Sachs FICC, Equities, and Prime Services data as of 2-Oct-26. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

US Shares Sales Trading

Ariana Contessa

ariana.contessa@gs.com

Matthew Kaplan, CFA

matthew.kaplan@gs.com

Chloe Garber

chloe.garber@gs.com

Mitch Jeter

mitch.jeter@gs.com

NDX eclipsed a new ATH to end the week, blowing through prev highs set on 6/3 (touched again on 9/22). Set against that, equal-weight S&P is down seven straight weeks which speaks to continued concentration into Tech, at expense of other sectors in market, which got more pronounced in September. Rates continue to garner all the attention, especially today after backing up to pre-(softer) NFP levels. No smoking gun from our rates colleagues outside of very few buyers of duration.

Asset Mgrs and HFs equity flows finished balanced on the week with one notable theme: uptick of demand in Semis on positive catalysts (solid MU earnings, NVDA \$150bn buyback increase, etc). Overall, it feels like there is minimal willingness to chase this move higher despite light positioning. Activity levels remain spotty given ongoing performance challenges, increasingly demanding macro backdrop (Oil, Rates), looming midterm overhang, and high velocity narrative shifts within AI.

Source: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities as of 2-Oct-26. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

Robert Quinn
robert.quinn@gs.com

Paul Leyzerovich
paul.leyzerovich@gs.com

Mason Fennelly
mason.fennelly@gs.com

Emily Robosson
emily.robosson@gs.com

Russell 2K is starting October in the green (+1.3% at time of writing), showing signs of stabilization after a difficult month of underperformance (-5.4% in Sep) that left the RTY/SPX ratio in the bottom quartile of its one-year range. Higher long-end yields, elevated rates volatility, and widening credit spreads disproportionately pressured Russell 2K. Positioning is deeply depressed, with GS systematic exposure in the 7th percentile and leveraged funds carrying record short exposure, according to CFTC data as of September 22 (Chart 1). Softer PCE and NFP data have eased rate expectations, with 30bp now priced through year-end, sparking short covering: OI has declined by \$900 million since September 29th, while RTY funding spreads have richened both outright and relative to SPX (Chart 2 - RTY vs. SPX). Sustained Russell 2K outperformance, however, will require durable relief in rates before end-user length can rebuild.

While Fed hike pricing provided some reprieve, the ongoing strength in deferred real rates and the Dollar weighed on Gold (-3.6% on the week as of mid-Friday). The option surface appears increasingly concerned, with 3 month normalized 25 delta put-call skew richening to a 2-month high and 62% 1-year rank prior to the Nonfarm payrolls release (Chart 3). The only solace for outstanding bulls: CTA positioning remains relatively short, leaving less momentum supply on continued weakness (Chart 4).

Chart 1:

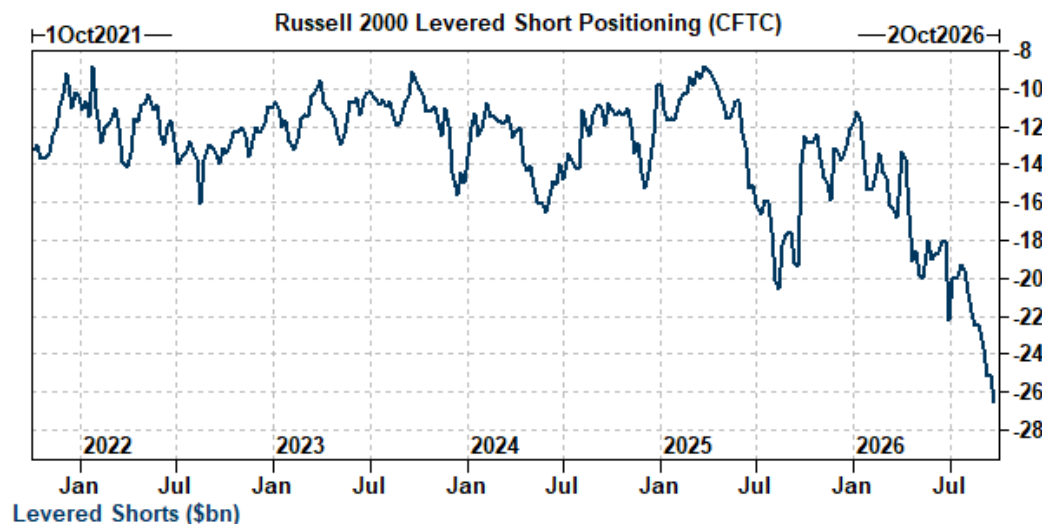


Chart 2:

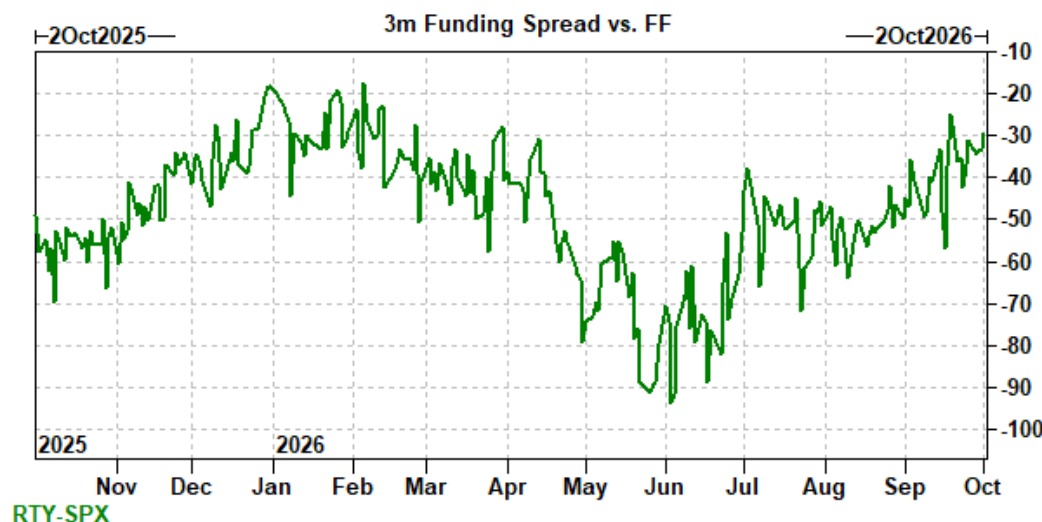


Chart 3:

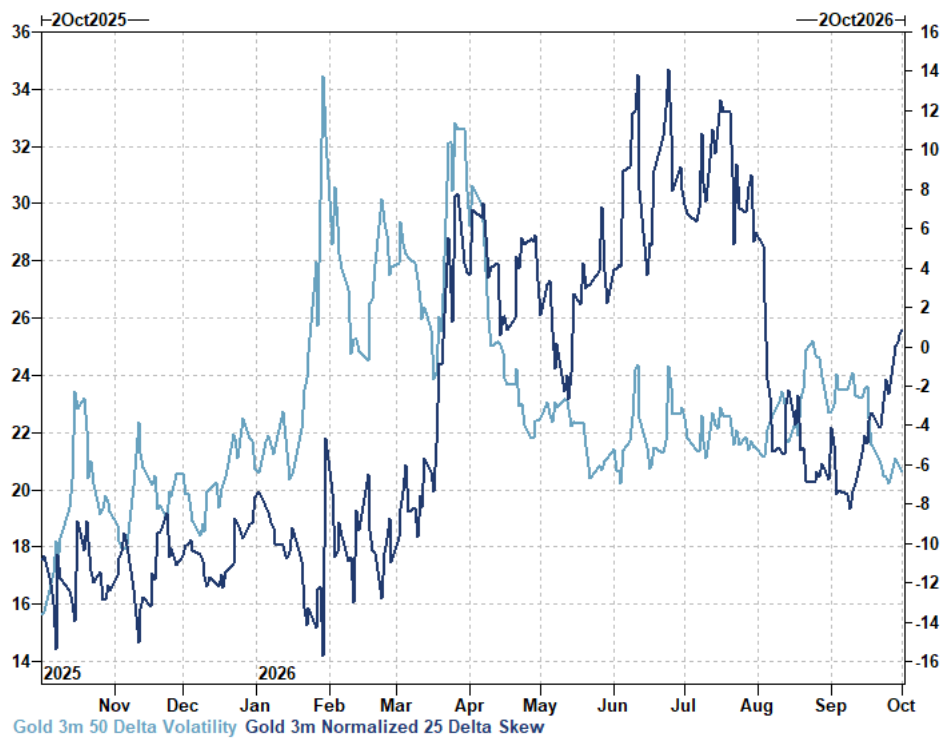
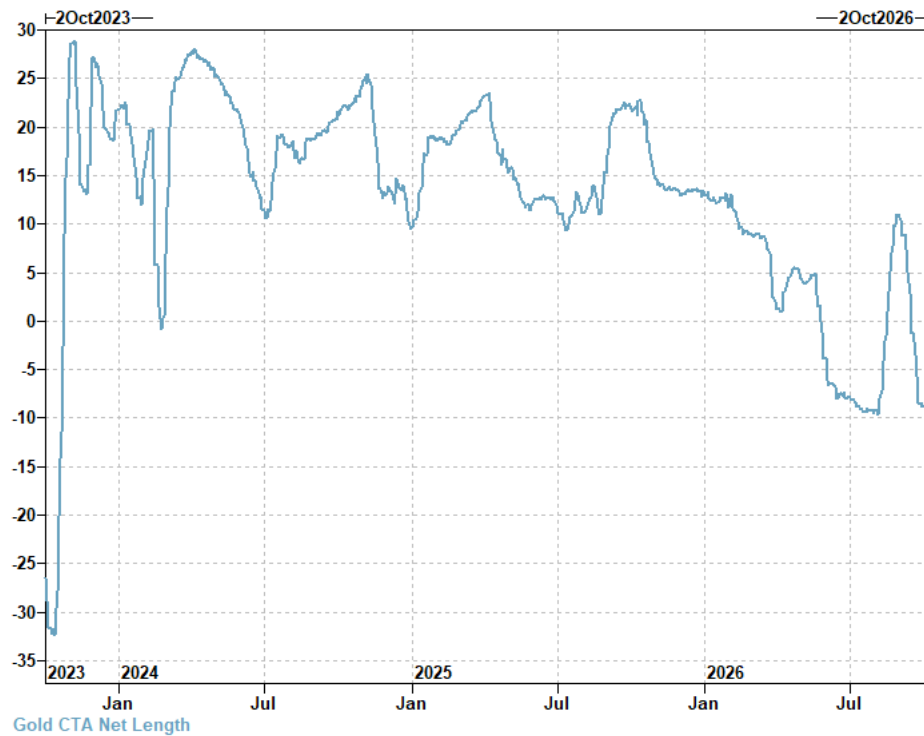


Chart 4:



Source for all charts: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Futures Strats Group as of 2-Oct-26, past performance not indicative of future results. All references to "we/us/our" refer to the views and observations of the desk.

Derivatives Sales Trading

Erin Briggs
erin.brigg@gs.com

Brian Garrett
brian.garrett@gs.com

Lee Coppersmith
lee.coppersmith@gs.com

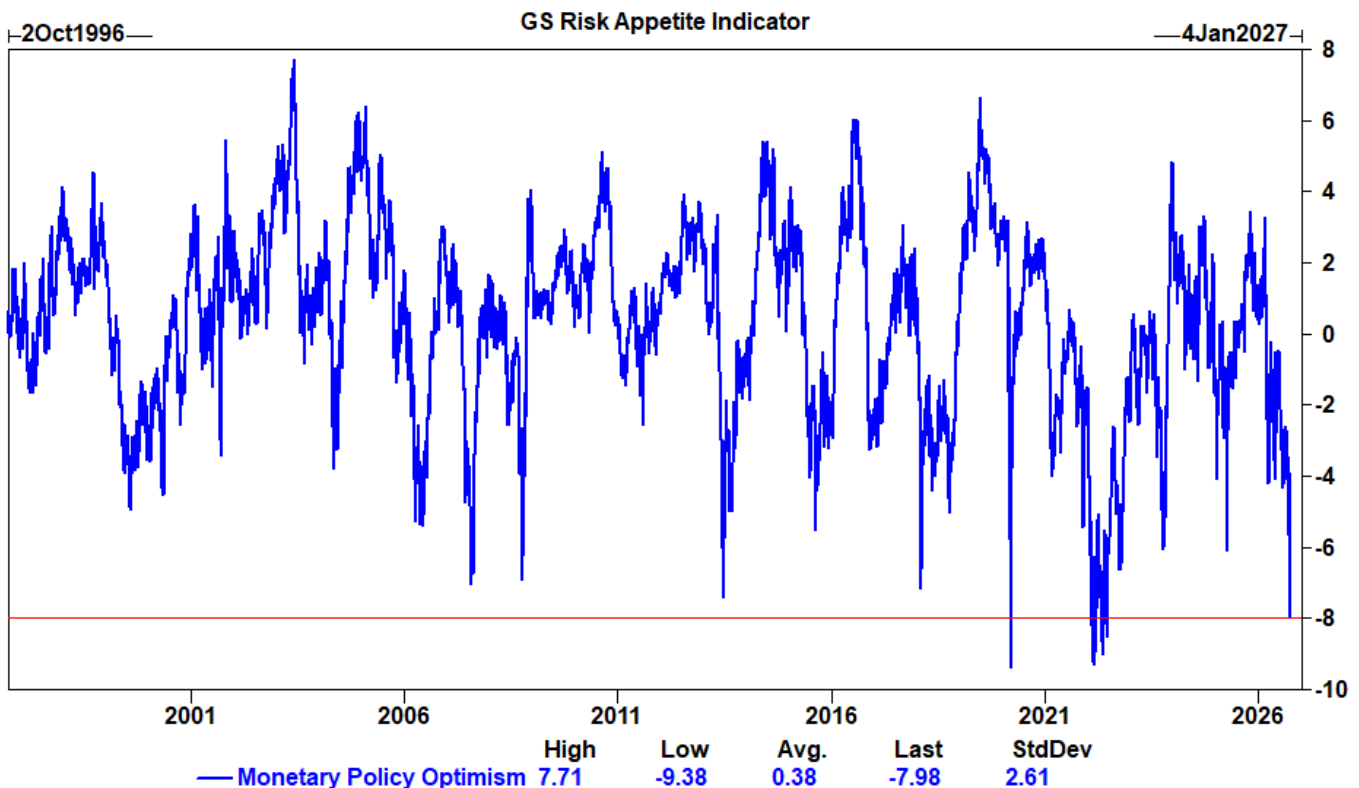
Cullen Morgan
cullen.morgan@gs.com

Gail Hafif
gail.hafif@gs.com

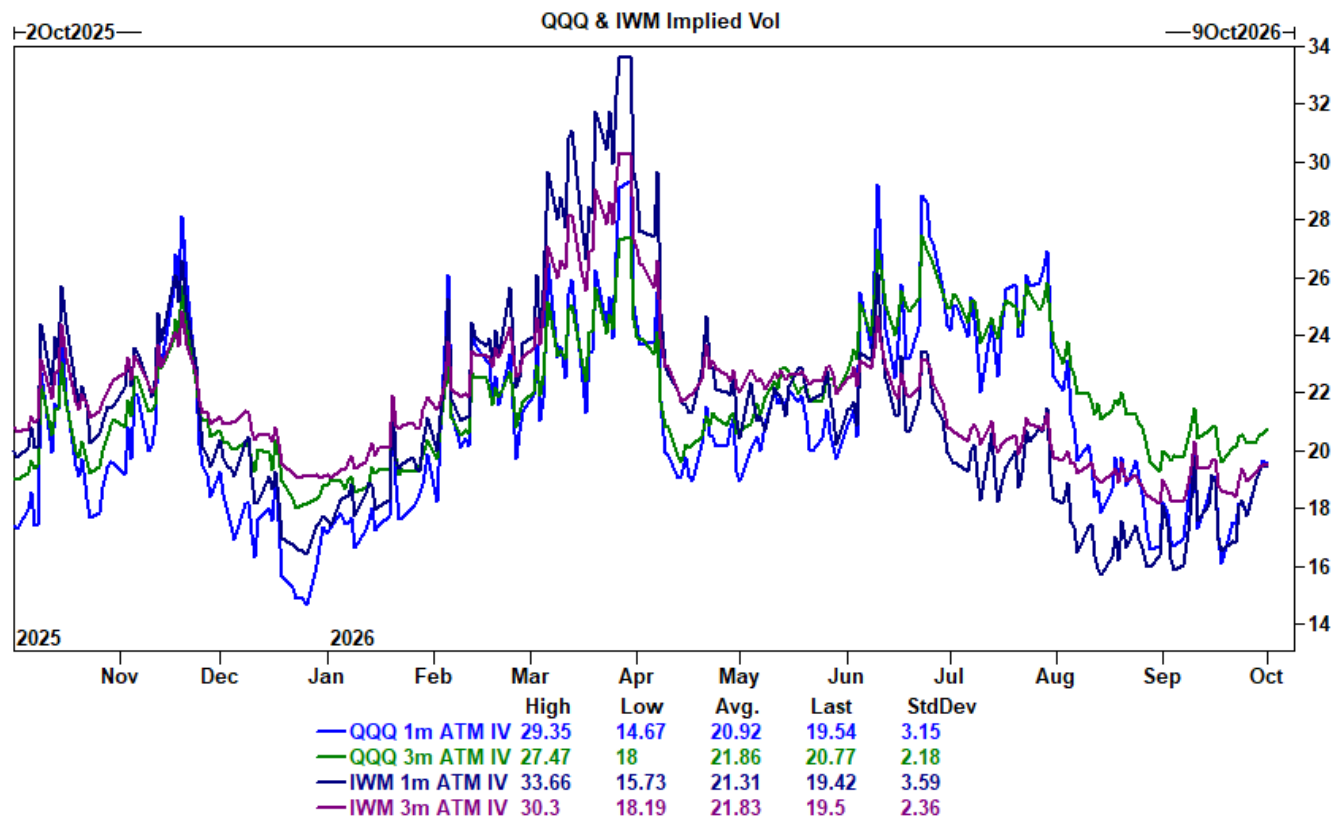
Robbie Stankard
robbie.stankard@gs.com

The macro backdrop continues to drive price action, with the markets focus on rates/oil leaving positioning depressed across the board – especially in vol. The internals are starting to look much more washed out than the headline index suggests.

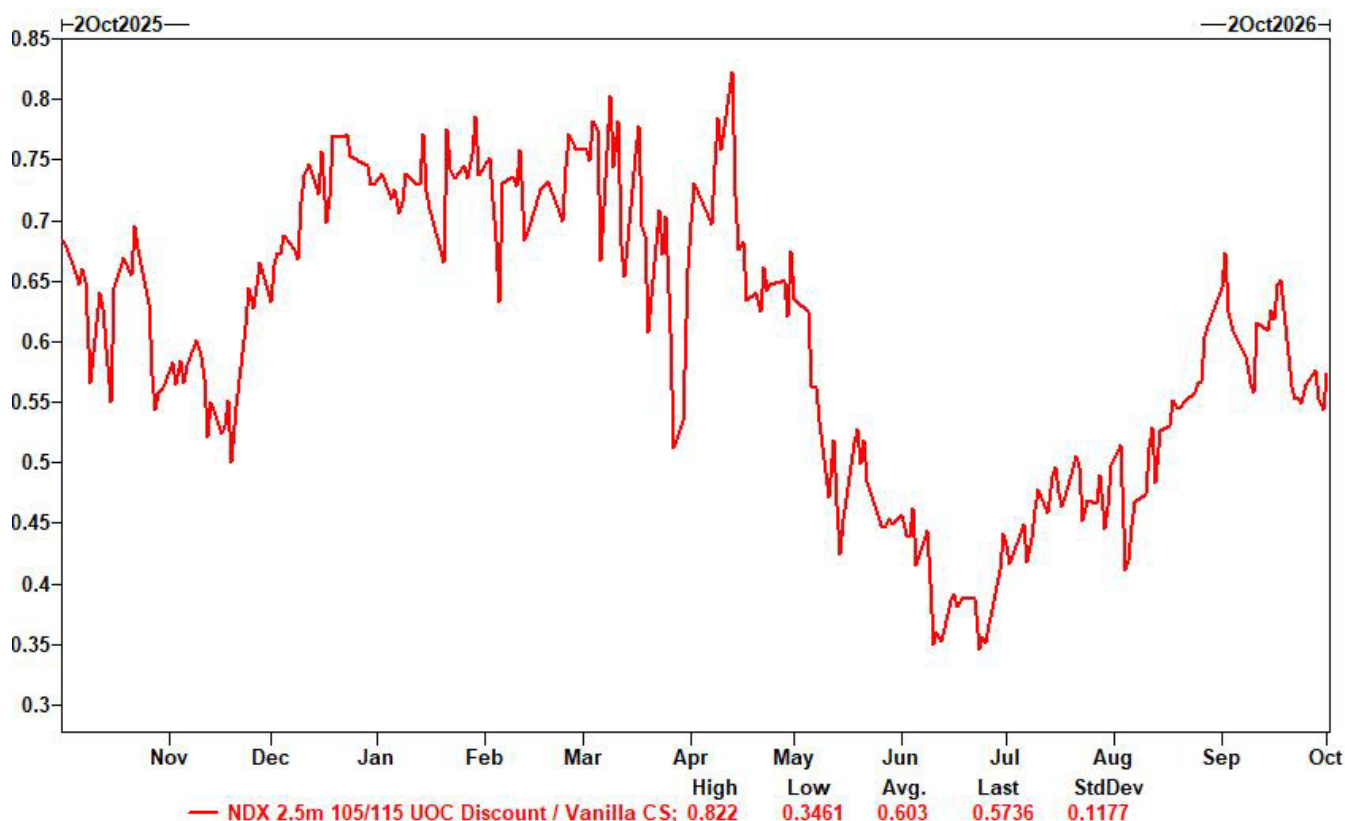
Our GS Monetary Policy Factor is at -8, basically at the bottom-end of the last 30 years (a lot of policy pessimism is reflected in the macro complex).



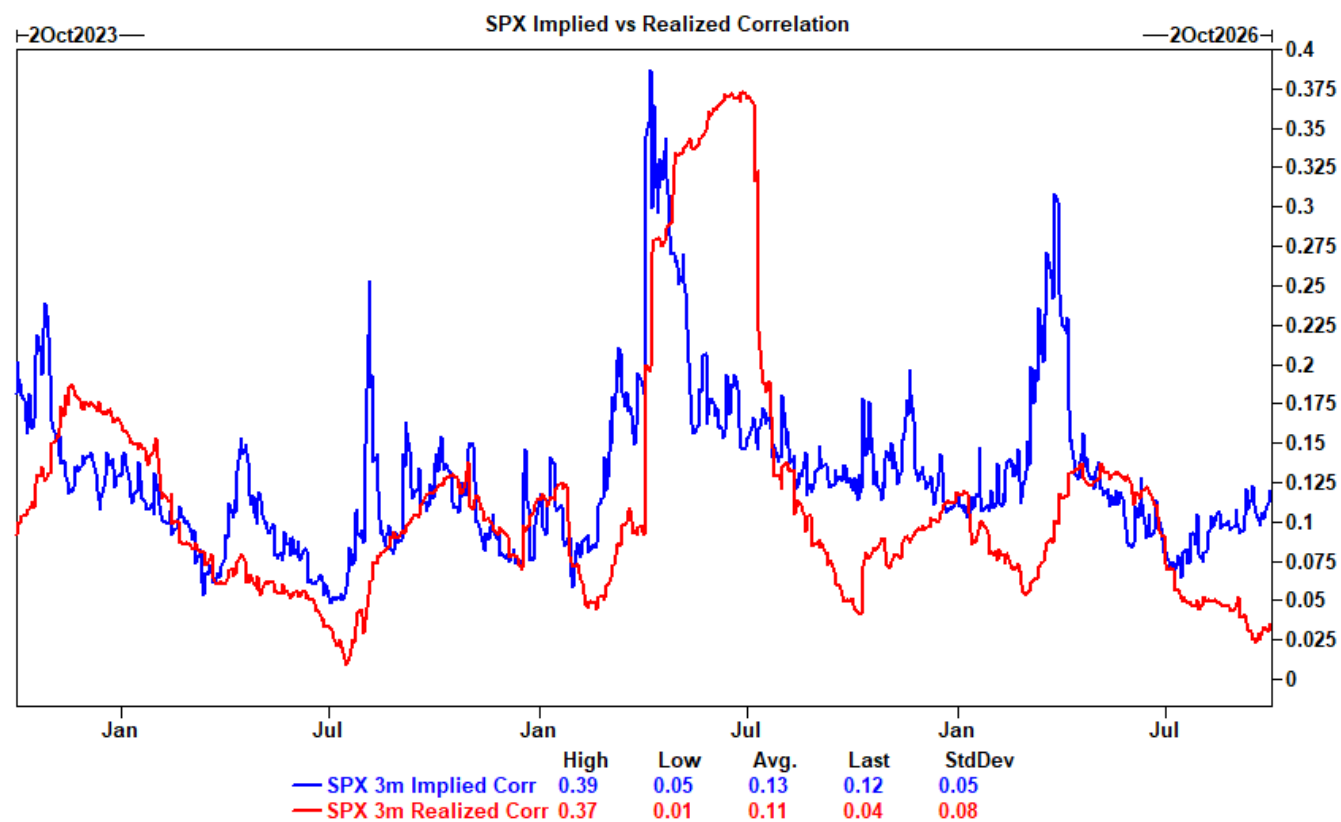
As we head into Q3 earnings and midterms, the desk likes IWM and QQQ upside here to capture the asymmetry to the upside. We are starting to see relief in rates/oil and think the market is underpositioned for EPS, especially in tech following continued news around agentic AI. QQQ 1m and 3m implied vols are in the 36th and 34th percentiles respectively on a 1y lookback (GS customer bought 30.5k QQQ 18Dec 850 calls on Fri) and IWM is similarly in 34th percentile for 1m and only 18th percentile for 3m.



This week we've seen plenty of activity on the exotic products front, specifically in NDX as it provides an attractive way to play for tech outperformance into earnings. The desk traded over 140mm of NDX Dec26 105% 115% Up and Out Calls which are currently trading in the 43rd percentile, slightly below average (vs 1.60% offer for the vanilla call spread). We also like NDX>RTY outperformance and NDX upvar as ways to isolate tech outperformance.



We are also watching the odds of a corr-1 move higher creep up. If rates, oil or the macro data continue to improve, there's a pretty clean setup for shorts to cover, underweights to get chased, and laggards to catch up. We think the move here is favoring owning upside convexity rather than chasing downside.



Source for all charts: Bloomberg, GS FICC and Equities as of 2-Oct-26, past performance not indicative of future results. All references to "we/us/our" refer to the views and observations of the desk.

Serena Tchorbajian
serena.tchorbajian@gs.com

Chris Lucas
chris.y.lucas@gs.com

1) Over \$1.5 trillion has poured into ETFs this year, surpassing last year's record annual haul in only three quarters. We can break this down into the following:

\$1.5 trillion over 3 quarters,

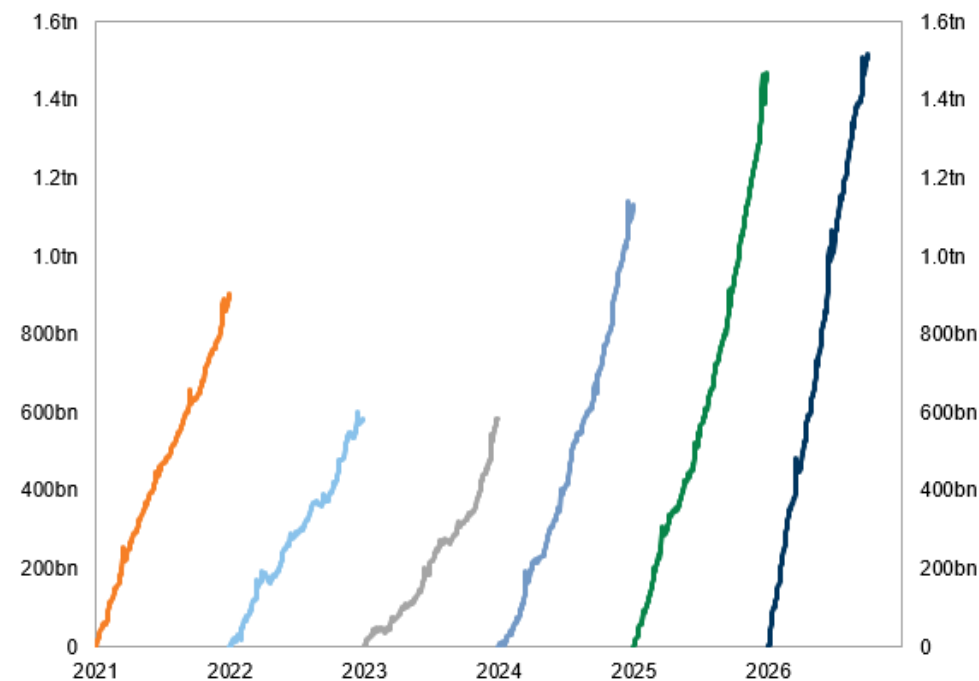
~\$167 billion/month,

~\$8 billion/session

Given these metrics (and seasonal Q4 [tailwinds](#)), we expect US ETF flows to surpass \$2 trillion in 2026.

US-Listed ETF Cumulative Fund Flow by Year

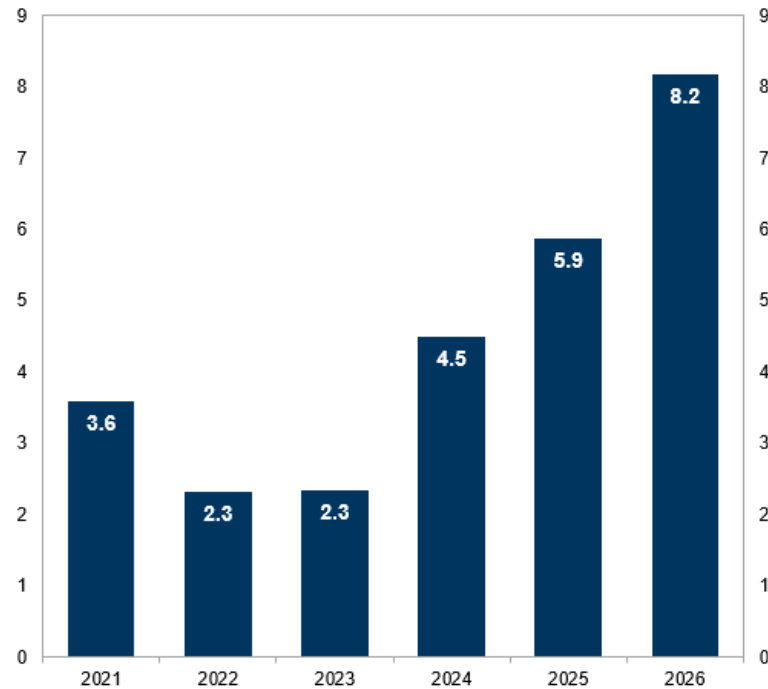
(values in \$)



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global FICC & Equities as of September 29, 2026. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

US-Listed ETFs: Average Daily Fund Flow by Year

(values in \$ billions)



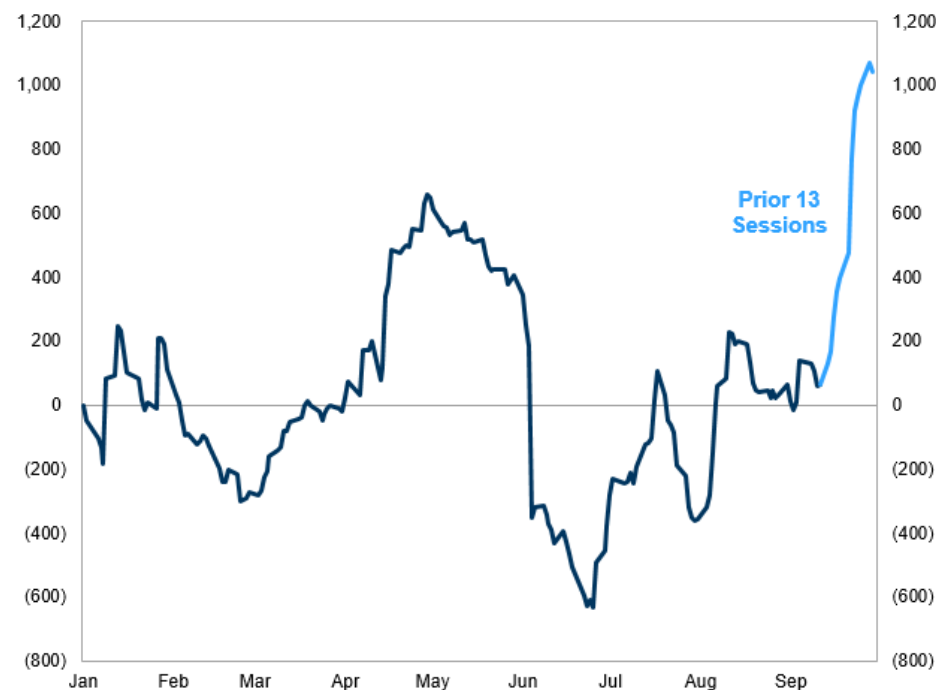
Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global FICC & Equities as of September 29, 2026. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

2) Across our desk, recent activity has illustrated the cross-asset firepower that ETFs offer (mega caps, thematic, rates/bonds/munis, crypto, etc., stats are as of 9/29).

i) SPX is on track to outperform RTY for 7 straight weeks (longest streak since 2018), coupled with XLK outperforming SPX for 6 straight weeks... **mega caps are providing much of the support, and demand in the market has recently sought conduits to concentrated exposures... MAGS has garnered 12 inflows over the past 13 sessions**, one of the fund's longest stretches of recurring demand since the fund launched years ago...

MAGS: YTD Cumulative Fund Flow

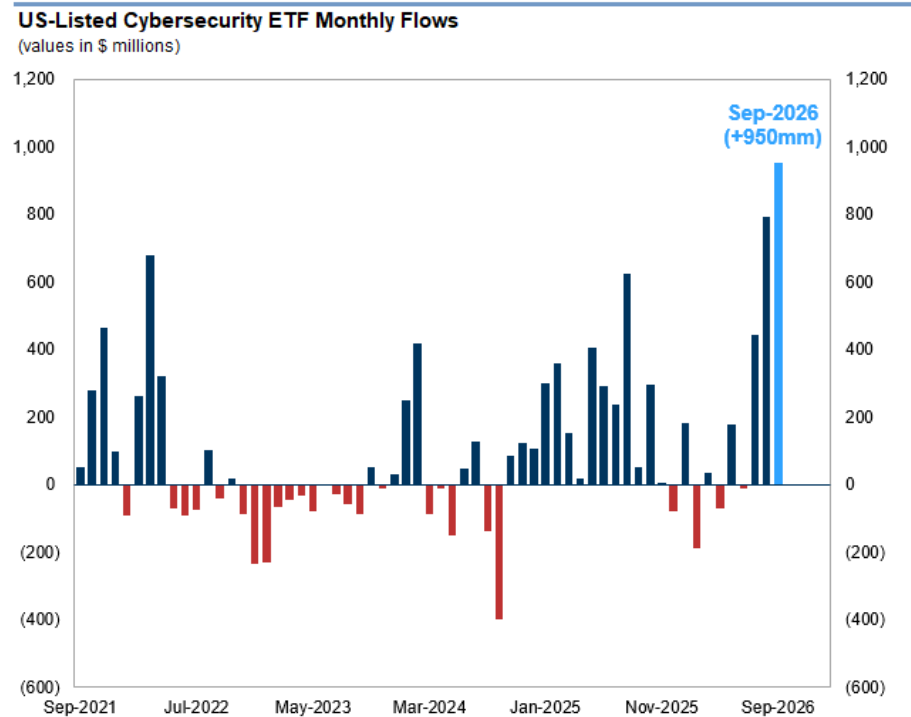
(values in \$ millions)



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global FICC & Equities as of September 29, 2026. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

...worth noting that RSP is on track for 7 consecutive weeks lower (which would tie its longest stretch), reaffirming the support at the top of the market cap spectrum.

ii) AI-fueled demand for cybersecurity exposure has the ETF complex on track for one of its best months of inflows in our dataset (+\$950mm)...



iii) In the fund's near 25 years of operating history, **TLT hit an all-time low this week...** further, the fund is on track for losses over 7 consecutive sessions (its longest daily stretch lower in 2 years)...

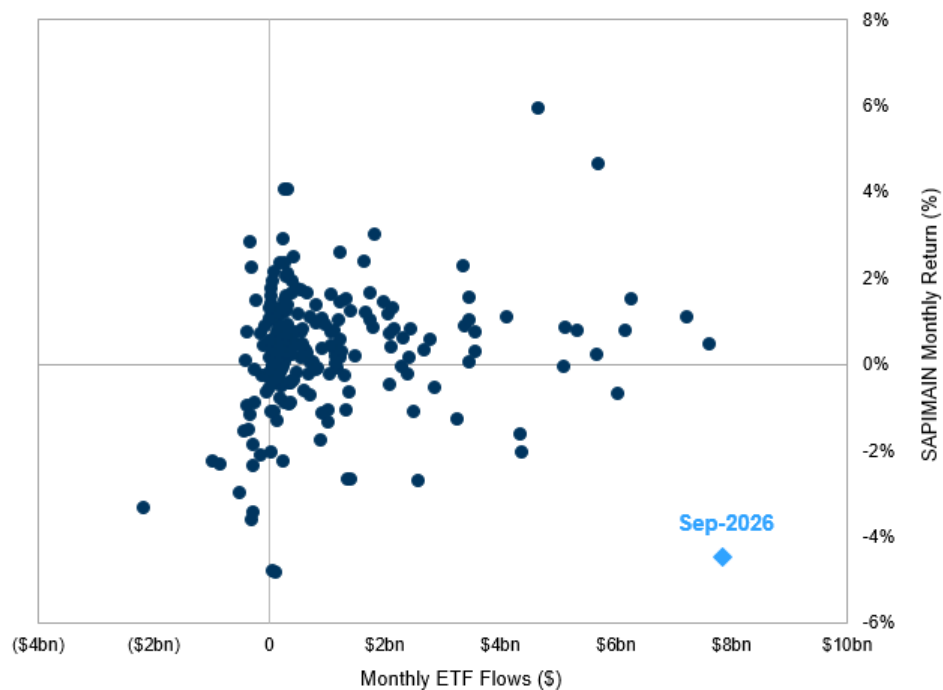


Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global FICC & Equities as of September 30, 2026. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

iv) Muni bond ETFs are collectively tracking for one of their worst months of index performance in 20 years, yet inflows persist supported tax loss harvesting rotations...

Municipal Bond ETF Monthly Flows vs. Index Return

(flows in \$ billions / index performance as total return %)

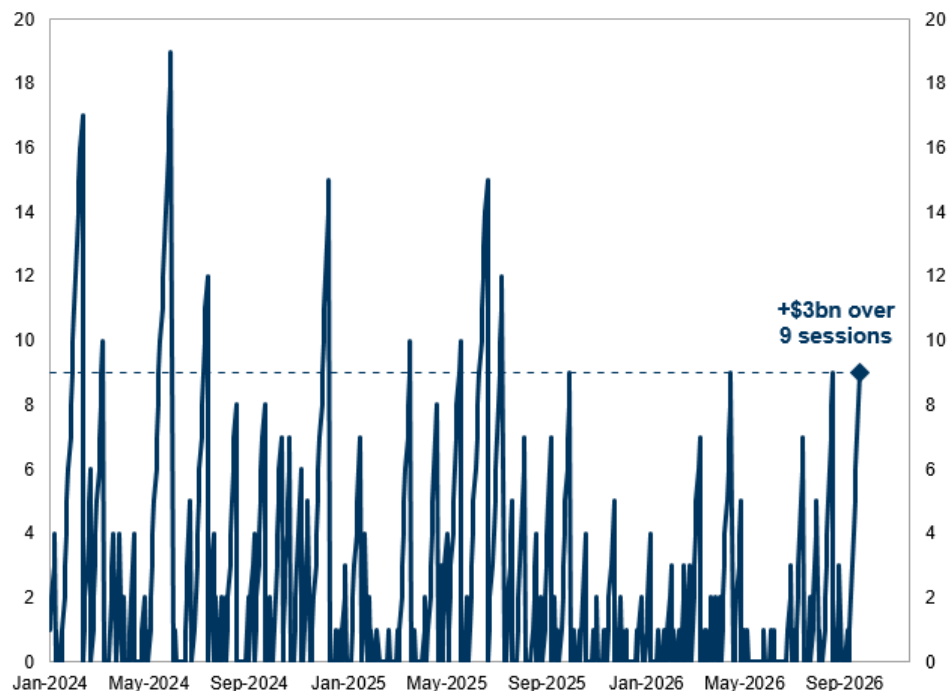


Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global FICC & Equities as of September 29, 2026. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

v) Worth flagging the continuation of market demand for spot-bitcoin ETFs... the complex has registered 9 consecutive days of inflows, totaling to more \$3 billion collected (its largest 9-day haul YTD)... The demand spans beyond the past two weeks, with over \$6 billion pouring into the complex over the past two months...

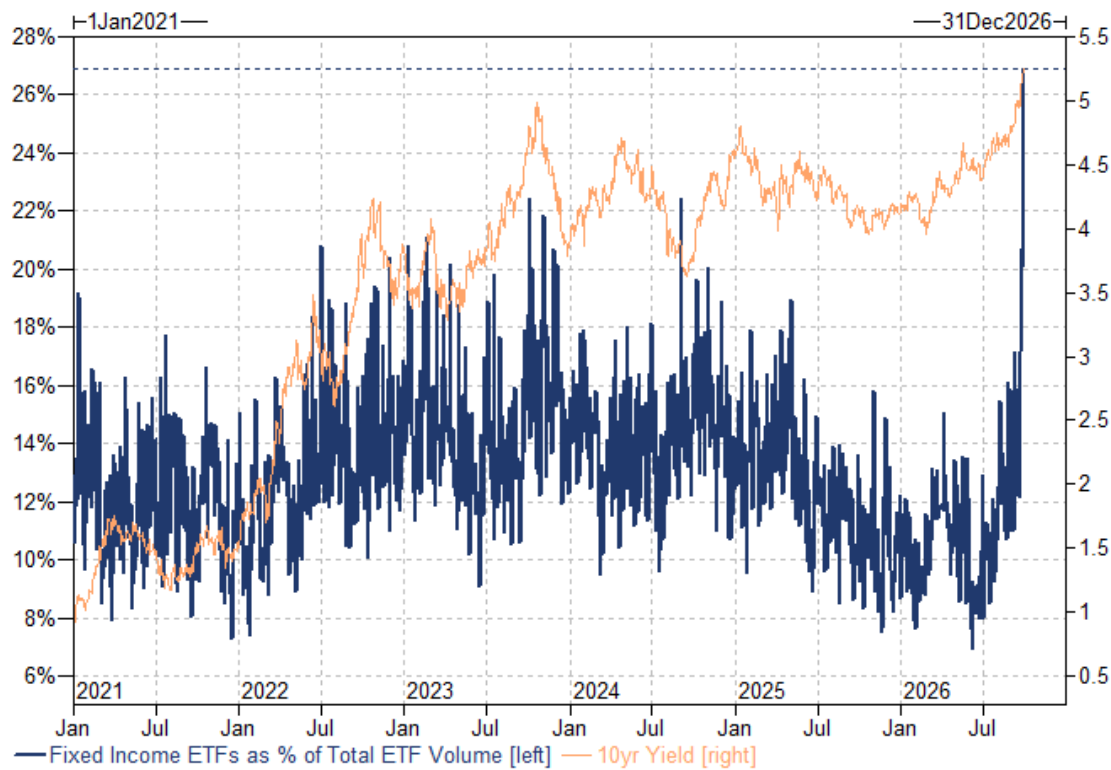
Spot-Bitcoin ETFs: Consecutive Daily Inflows

(values as number of market sessions)



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global FICC & Equities as of September 29, 2026. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

vi) We've spilled a lot of ink on the relationship between ETF trading volumes and market volatility -- as vol accelerates, so does ETF trading activity. We've seen a similar relationship coincide with the recent ascent in rates... **As the 10yr pushed through 5% this month, fixed income ETFs have seen a rapid acceleration in trading volumes...**



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global FICC & Equities as of September 29, 2026. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

Any references to we/us/our refers to the desk

Thematic Baskets and Macro Observations

Louis Miller
louis.miller@gs.com

Faris Mourad
faris.mourad@gs.com

Guillaume Soria
guillaume.soria@gs.com

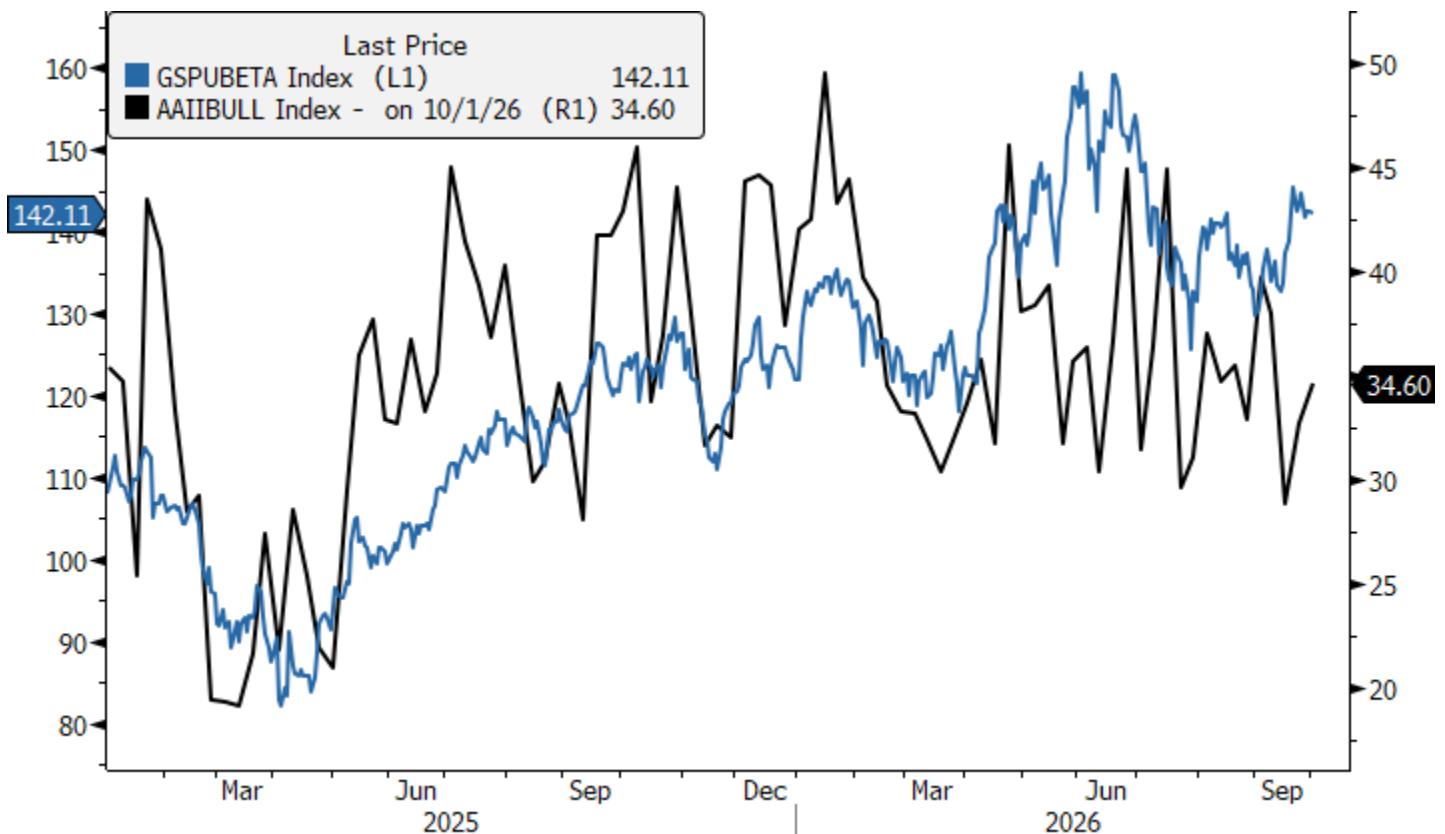
Julia Masch
julia.masch@gs.com

Shreya Ghaie
Shreya.Ghaie@gs.com

Rising oil prices, higher yields, and geopolitical uncertainty have weighed on high-beta equities over the past few months, leaving the factor to emerge from one of its most volatile stretches in recent history. Beta is among the most rate-sensitive factors in the market, and we have seen continued demand for beta hedging over the past few months in anticipation of a higher-rate regime. Friday's softer payroll print pushed yields lower without being soft enough to spark recession fears — this could provide a strong tailwind for equities, where weak market breadth and light net positioning leave room for a catch-up rally from laggards.

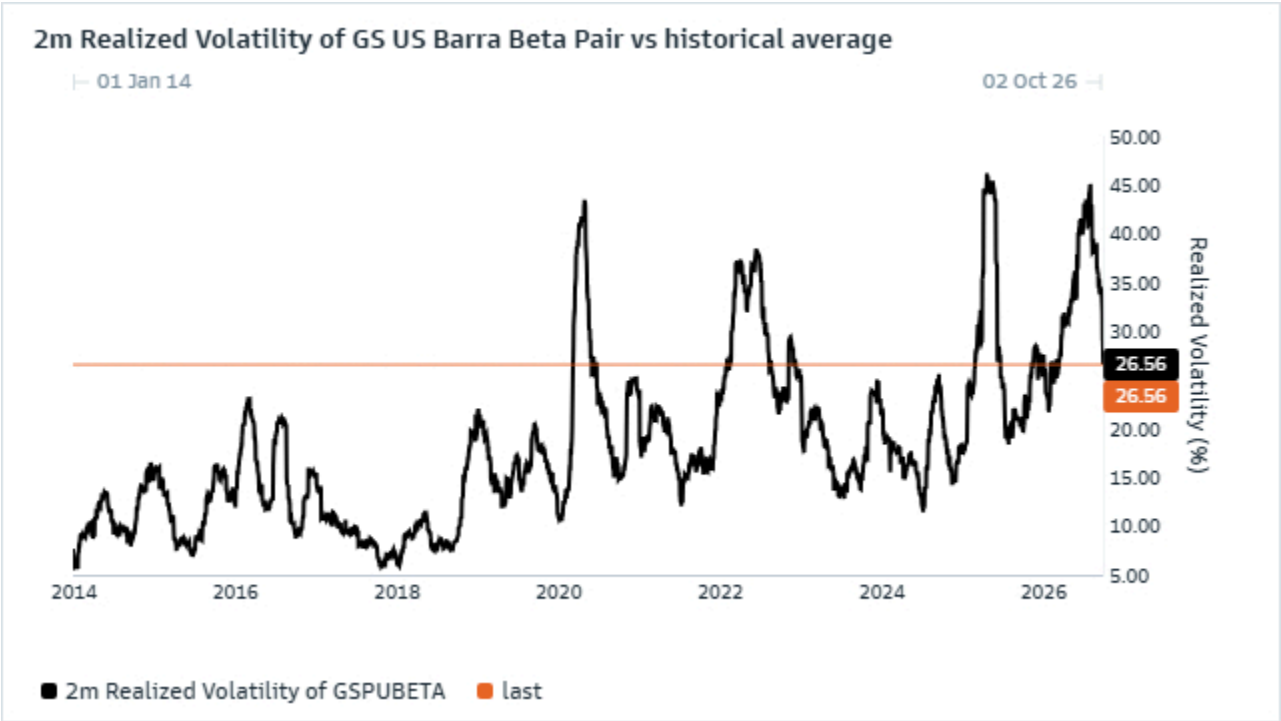
For clients looking for upside on high-beta stocks, we like our GS sector/industry-neutral basket, [GSPUBETA](#). For clients looking to manage their beta exposure (which is at the 83rd percentile over the last 5 years in our Prime book), we like hedging with our Beta-ex-AI pair ([GSPUBETX](#)).

GS Beta Pair has been trending with the AAI Investor Sentiment Bullish readings



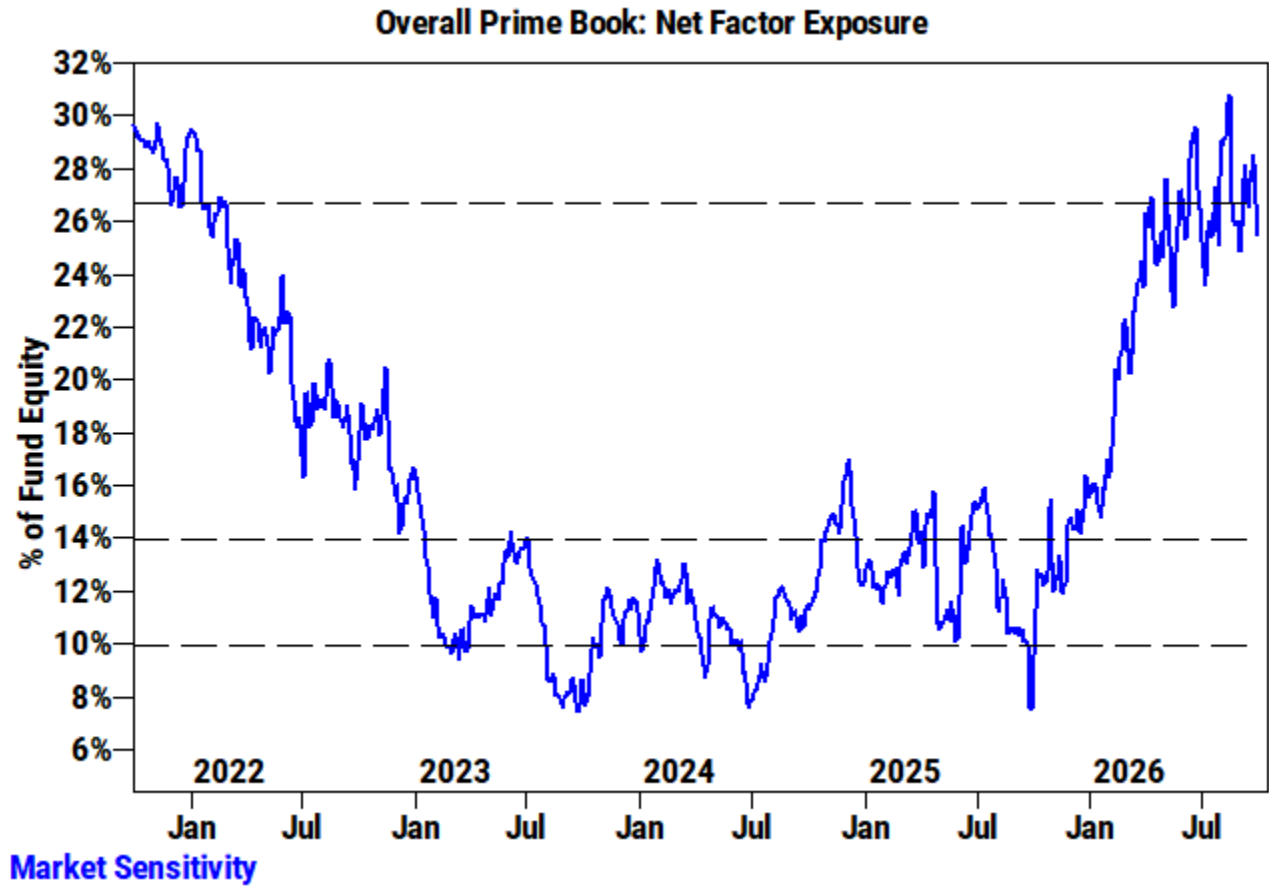
AAIIBULL Index (AAII US Investor Sentiment Bullish Readings) Bulls vs Beta Daily 01JAN2025-02OCT2026 Copyright© 2026 Bloomberg Finance L.P. 02-Oct-2026 09:00:15

Volatility of the beta factor has been extremely elevated recently



Source: Marquee [PlotTool Pro](#) as of 02 Oct 2026, past performance is not indicative of future returns, access plot [HERE](#)

Beta Exposure in our Prime Book is hovering around the 90th percentile



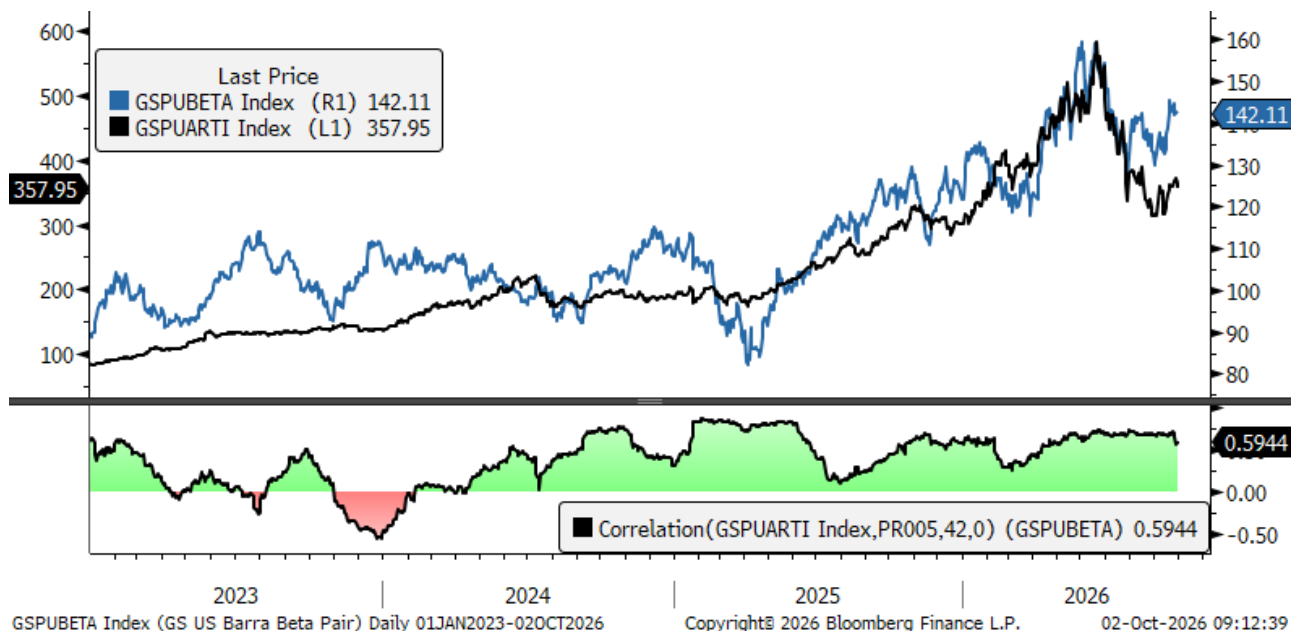
Source: Goldman Sachs Prime Brokerage Services, as of Sept 2026. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

High Beta themes have been linked to the AI complex and continue to be high momentum

Theme	Ticker	Beta	Momentum	YTD
AI Semis	GSCBSMHX	1.40	0.79	91%
Memory	GSTMTMEM	1.22	0.96	191%
Robotics & Automation	GSXUROBO	0.98	0.09	38%
Optical Networks	GSXUOPTI	0.87	0.43	89%
AI Inference Chips	GSXUINFR	0.85	0.72	114%
Datacenters	GSTMTDAT	0.77	0.35	90%
High Beta 12M Winners	GSXUHMOM	0.71	0.57	44%
Sensors	GSXUSENS	0.68	0.06	51%
US Metals	GSXUMETL	0.65	0.61	19%
Global Rare Earths	GSXGRARE	0.62	-0.05	-12%
Grid Revamp	GSXUGRID	0.56	-0.36	30%
60% AI + 40% Energy Bottleneck	GSCBBOTL	-0.35	0.41	52%
De-Regulation Beneficiaries	GSXUDREG	-0.43	0.19	20%
Defense Spending	GSXUDFNS	-0.43	-0.74	-11%
Liquid Regional Banks	GSCBRGBK	-0.45	-0.19	9%
Obesity Drugs	GSHLCBMI	-0.48	0.15	-1%
Commodity Sensitive	GSXUCOMO	-0.57	0.44	23%
Consumer Inertia	GSXUSWCH	-0.59	-0.38	-14%
Compounders	GSXUCOMP	-0.64	-0.21	0%
ACA Beneficiaries	GSHLCACA	-0.76	-0.23	2%
Defensives ex-Commods (Index)	GSX1DEFS	-0.98	-0.40	3%
Expensive Defensives	GSXUEDEF	-1.08	-0.14	-1%
Geopolitical Risk	GSXUGEOP	-1.08	0.22	25%
Nat Gas	GSENNATG	-1.12	-0.21	0%
Bond Proxies	GSXUBOND	-1.22	-0.63	-2%
Oil	GSENOILB	-1.64	0.43	35%

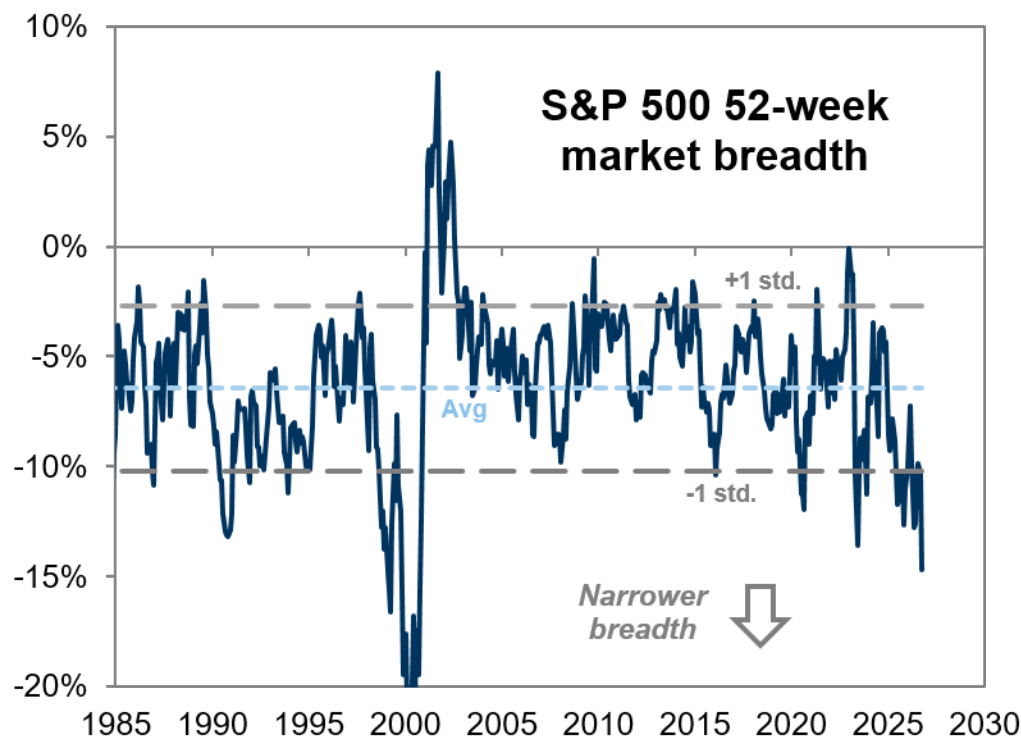
Source: Bloomberg, Marquee, Goldman Sachs FICC & Equities, as of Sept 2026; past performance is not indicative of future returns.

As a result, the correlation of our beta pair to momentum has been strongly positive in the last few years



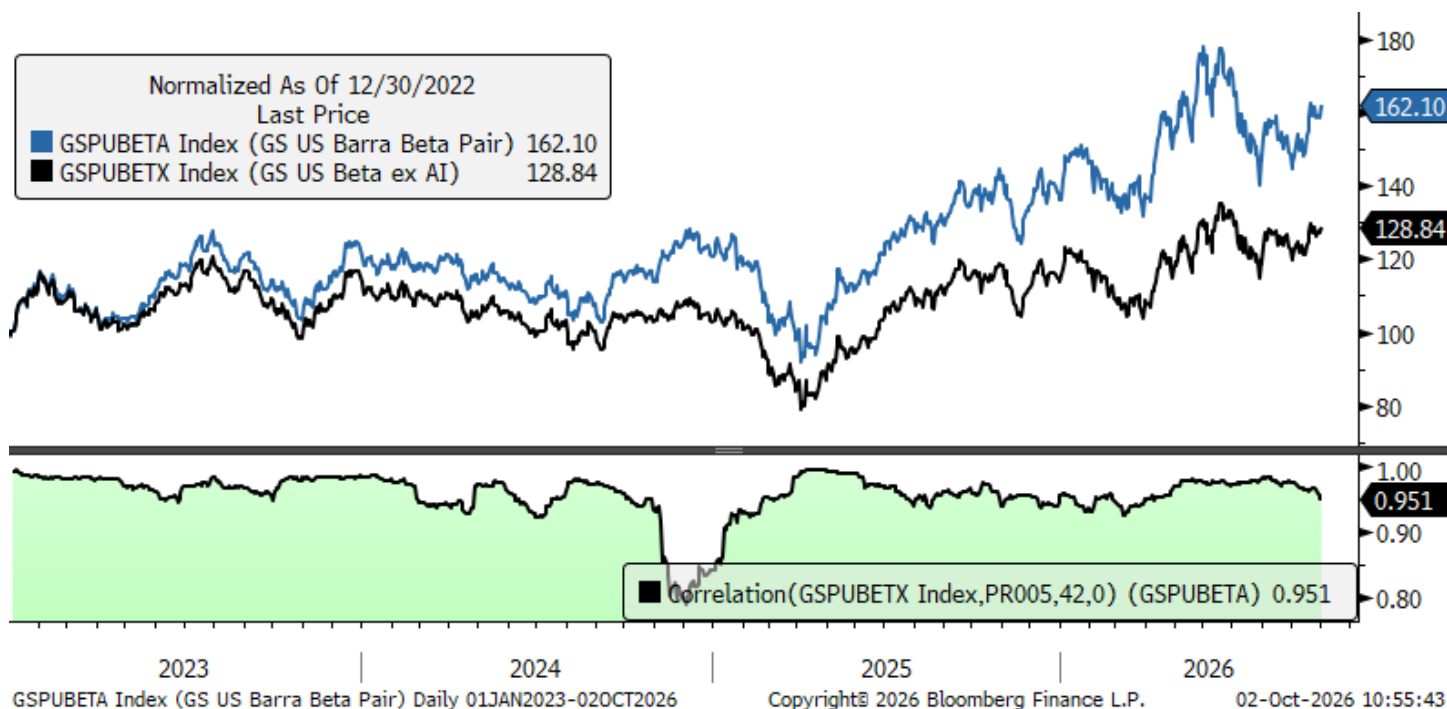
Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs FICC & Equities, as of Sept 2026; past performance is not indicative of future returns.

Market continues to have bad breadth and this could lead to a catch up following the rate relief and light positioning on our Prime Book



Source: GIR, as of Sept 2026; past performance is not indicative of future returns.

Clients looking to hedge their beta exposure could benefit from GSPUBETX which has underperformed the Beta basket while maintaining consistent high correlation



Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs FICC & Equities, as of Sept 2026; past performance is not indicative of future returns.

GS US Factor Monitor

Ticker	%1D	%5D	%1M	%YTD ↓	Std Dev	Ticker
▼ US Barra (USMEDS) Pair Indices (9)						
▸ Quality (Hi/Lo)	-0.67%	+2.52%	+8.1%	+9.5%	-1.0	GSP1QUAL
▸ Earnings Yield (Hi/Lo)	-0.13%	+8.4%	+1.6%	+8.2%	-.5	GSP1ERNY
▸ Value (Cheap/Expensive)	-0.27%	-.82%	-1.9%	+6.5%	-.7	GSP1VALU
▸ Momentum (Hi/Lo)	+0.81%	+3.56%	+9.8%	+5.8%	.5	GSP1MOMO
▸ Growth (Hi/Lo)	-0.42%	-.17%	+.3%	+2.5%	-.9	GSP1GRWT
▸ Leverage (Hi/Lo)	+0.21%	-1.71%	-5.0%	-.8%	.6	GSP1LEVG
▸ Res Vol (Hi/Lo)	-0.45%	+7.2%	+1.5%	-2.0%	-.5	GSP1RSVL
▸ Profitability (Hi/Lo)	-0.40%	-.88%	-3.2%	-3.1%	-.5	GSP1PROF
▸ Size (Large/Small)	-0.77%	-2.20%	+1.5%	-8.4%	-1.6	GSP1SIZE
▼ US Barra (USACS1LTS) *NEW* Cross-Sector Factor Pairs (5)						
▸ US Barra (USACS1LTS) Beta Pair	+1.48%	+1.30%	+12.5%	+26.5%	.7	GSPUBABT
▸ US Barra (USACS1LTS) Momentum Pair	+1.51%	+3.18%	+13.0%	+4.7%	.9	GSPUBAMO
▸ US Barra (USACS1LTS) Residual Volatility Pair	-1.03%	+.53%	-2.2%	-1.2%	-1.4	GSPUBARV
▸ US Barra (USACS1LTS) Short Interest Pair	+0.17%	-1.83%	-1.7%	-5.4%	.4	GSPUBASI
▸ US Barra (USACS1LTS) Size Pair	-0.58%	-2.97%	-.8%	-7.1%	-1.1	GSPUBASZ
▼ xAI Factor Solutions (3)						
▸ Beta ex AI (Hi/Lo)	+1.00%	-.22%	+6.5%	+13.1%	.6	GSPUBETX
▸ Momentum ex AI (Hi/Lo)	+1.07%	+3.10%	+11.8%	+10.2%	.7	GSPUMOXX
▸ Res Vol ex AI (Hi/Lo)	-0.13%	+1.07%	-.8%	-5.2%	-.2	GSPURVXX
▼ Momentum (13)						
▸ High Beta TMT Momentum (Hi/Lo)	+3.01%	+6.74%	+25.5%	+45.1%	.6	GSTMTMOM
▸ High Beta Momentum (Hi/Lo)	+2.34%	+6.92%	+30.7%	+23.5%	.6	GSPRHIMO
▸ Financials Momentum (Hi/Lo)	+1.47%	+2.29%	+5.3%	+15.3%	1.6	GSFIMOMO
▸ Industrial Momentum (Hi/Lo)	+1.28%	+4.15%	+11.2%	+14.4%	.8	GSINMOMO
▸ Cross Sector Momo ex AI	+1.07%	+3.10%	+11.8%	+10.2%	.7	GSPUMOXX
▸ TMT Momentum (Hi/Lo)	+0.81%	+2.15%	+14.8%	+8.1%	.5	GSTMOMOM
▸ Broad Momentum (Hi/Lo)	+0.81%	+3.56%	+9.8%	+5.8%	.5	GSP1MOMO
▸ US Barra (USACS1LTS) Momentum (Hi/Lo)	+1.51%	+3.18%	+13.0%	+4.7%	.9	GSPUBAMO
▸ 6m Momentum (Hi/Lo)	+2.18%	+5.61%	+27.4%	+1.6%	.6	GSPRHMO6
▸ 3m Momentum (Hi/Lo)	-2.51%	+.35%	-3.9%	+1.3%	-.7	GSPRHMO3
▸ Energy Momentum (Hi/Lo)	-1.70%	+2.48%	+11.2%	-1.8%	-1.2	GSENMOM
▸ Health Care Momentum (Hi/Lo)	+0.80%	+3.91%	+6.5%	-11.7%	.7	GSHCMOMO
▸ Consumer Momentum (Hi/Lo)	+0.38%	+1.42%			.5	GSCNMOMO
▼ Beta (8)						
▸ TMT Beta (Hi/Lo)	+1.74%	+2.31%	+11.5%	+40.7%	.9	GSTMBETA
▸ Industrial Beta (Hi/Lo)	+0.92%	+1.59%	+10.0%	+28.8%	.5	GSINBETA
▸ US Barra (USACS1LTS) Beta (Hi/Lo)	+1.48%	+1.30%	+12.5%	+26.5%	.7	GSPUBABT
▸ Cross-Sector Beta (Hi/Lo)	+1.51%	-.14%	+10.3%	+18.6%	.7	GSPUBETA
▸ Cross-Sector Beta ex AI (Hi/Lo)	+1.00%	-.22%	+6.5%	+13.1%	.6	GSPUBETX
▸ Consumer Beta (Hi/Lo)	-0.01%	+.85%	+3.3%	+12.8%	.0	GSCNBETA
▸ Financials Beta (Hi/Lo)	+0.38%	-.90%	-.2%	-1.2%	.3	GSFIBETA
▸ Health Care Beta (Hi/Lo)	+0.62%	-2.19%			.3	GSHCBETA

Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs FICC & Equities, as of Sept 2026; past performance is not indicative of future returns.

Sector Specialists Highlights

Peter Callahan
peter.callahan@gs.com

Scott Feiler
scott.feiler@gs.com

Jonathan Chan
jonathan.chan@gs.com

Christian DeGrasse
christian.m.degrasse@gs.com

Ryan Novak
ryan.novak@gs.com

Adam Wijaya
adam.x.wijaya@gs.com

TMT (Pete Callahan and Alexander Joseph)

Semis continued to re-gain their footing (SOX +4% vs NDX +70bps) in another long week with continued factor rotations under the surface (Flagging our High Beta Mo' Pair +8% on the week – "Remember me!?)... The past five days have delivered TMT Investors "wrong-way" reactions to earnings prints (Think ACN to the upside... Muted MU reaction & JBL fade...), Developer Days, AI Model releases, and an ever-present focus on the macro landscape to reckon with. Zooming out, as pencil sharpening of expects begins ahead of EPS season, the valuation backdrop looks un-demanding with NDX's 12m fwd multiple sitting below its multi-year average. With calendar turning to Q4, there remains healthy debate in our conversations around fully re-committing to the AI "trade" given the challenging/uncertain macro landscape (rates/oil) & upcoming mid-terms. While there is solid investor confidence around steady/improving bottoms-up fundamentals (Continued puts and takes around personal agents), question marks remain around the ability for share prices to reflect positive earnings results & deliver follow-through... Said another way, when does the period of multiple compression end and sustained belief in 2027-2028 begin?

Financials & Real Estate (Christian DeGrasse)

Financials and Real Estate both lagged SPX this week, with rates continuing to remain in focus among specialists worried the fast move & coinciding rate volatility will create a drag on capital markets activity & broader growth. Within Consumer Finance & Capital markets specifically, the move in rates has rekindled questions around where we are in the cycle, reflecting sentiment that appears to stand in contrast with other sectors/corners of the market. From a single stock perspective, we'd flag an acute focus on stocks with leverage (& recent deal announcements), while conversations around Agentic/AI risk cooled down; though impacted stocks only partially retraced their underperformance. Going forward, the focus is firmly shifting towards earnings with the big banks kicking things off roughly 1.5 weeks from now.

Healthcare (Jon Chan)

Healthcare lagged this week (XLV -2.8% vs. SPY flat) with an unfavorable macro overlay for HC with SMH/AI outperformance – meanwhile the turn of the month/qtr has not catalyzed a dramatic change in the status quo of focus at the subsector level – where SMID biotech has continued to have a negative bias in recent news flow (QURE, LQDA, NKTR, REGN, etc.) and where specialist positioning has remained a pain point (though has shown some leveling off of crowding factor de-grossing though pockets of squeezey/covering still playing out), HC services did receive clarity on one near-term overhang (CVS's distribution contract) though broader angst remains ahead of Medicare STARS for Managed Care and Tools momentum saw a brief pause/retracement though quickly snapped back Friday.

Industrials & Materials (Ryan Novak)

Main debate right now is when to re-gross in industrials and materials, why to re-gross and where to re-gross. Investors appear in a holding pattern driven by the macro – Middle East, oil, rates and midterms. While seasonality gets better historically the rest of the year, until we have clarity on any of the items listed, expect cyclicals to remain for sale. Industrials inflected lower broadly and are trading at 1 and 5 year lows vs. the broader market. Sentiment has soured across all the previously popular areas including AI/data center, short cycle, aerospace and transports. What catalysts matter most in October: New data points – ISM, truck orders, auto sales. And importantly, Q3 earnings where the battle becomes topline strength vs. price/cost headwinds and macro uncertainty that has risen dramatically in recent months.

Energy & Utilities (Adam Wijaya)

'Fade energy' continues to dominate conversations on the desk with specialists – with more caution on relative upside to crude at current levels and potential policy intervention on the products front. Refining has been the most topical subsector on the desk – with strong inbounds on potential knock-on effects of a diesel export ban or quota. OFS conversations are broadly highlighting near term downside risk to International exposed names, while NAM is more idiosyncratic on the pricing / utilization fronts – where we think specialists remain more constructive on defensive, diversified large caps. Where are conversations turning more positive? Integrated (US + CAD) – the group has lagged YTD relative to broader Energy, generally more defensive in an Energy pullback and 3Q setups are expected to be strong – specifically on trading and downstream.

Source: Goldman Sachs FICC & Equities as of 2-Oct-26. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

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